

You're an educator. It's time New York paid you like one.

Whether you run a family child care program, teach in a center, or assist in a classroom, your work makes every other job in New York possible. Yet child care educators earn less than 96% of the state's workers, and family child care (FCC) providers in NYC take home a median of **$6.01 an hour**. Together, we can change that in the 2027 state budget.

$1.8B

A wage scale for child care workers

Thriving wages for every provider in New York, in centers and in homes, without raising what families pay.

$1.2B

CCAP for every eligible family

Fully fund child care assistance so no family is waitlisted, your classroom stays full, and your payments are fair and on time.

What a wage scale means for you

- **Pay like a public school teacher** when you have the same credentials, and a fair share of it with a CDA, associate's or bachelor's degree.
- **Your experience counts.** Every year in the field moves you up the scale.
- **Family child care starts 10% higher,** because you run a business as well as teach.
- **No new costs for parents** and no interference with your union contract.

Why now

- New York is expanding free and low-cost care. If providers aren't paid, the expansion is built on our backs.
- Family child care capacity fell **28%** since 2019. We can't afford to lose more of us.

Real providers, real raises

PROVIDER	NOW	SCALE
Family child care in NYC, high school diploma, 21 years	$33,280	**$79,184**
Teacher in NYC, associate degree, 3 years	$40,000	**$69,836**
Family child care in Buffalo, high school diploma, 11 years	$33,280	**$53,792**

Get involved

- **Come to the launch** on Wed, Dec 2 from 11 AM to 1 PM in Albany, Buffalo or NYC. Bring your families! Register at popny.org/dec2.
- **Join a POP campaign committee** in your area.
- **Tell your story** to your legislators and the press.

Sources: Schuyler Center from NYS DOL data (2025); L. Melodia, Center for NYC Affairs (2026); OCFS data; CUNY-PDI wage scale scenarios; Empire State Campaign for Child Care 2027 priorities.

PROVIDERS ORGANIZED FOR POWER · the action lab · Empire State Campaign for Child Care · UFT · Citizen Action · New York Communities for Change · AQE Alliance for Quality Education · ECE On The Move · ILR Worker Institute · United Neighborhood Houses

popny.org/dec2

Register for the Dec 2 launch · Campaign: popny.org/pay

Questions?
info@popchildcare.org